Microsoft 365 Copilot

Analytics Implementation Guide

A Step-by-Step Procedural Guide

Document Property	Value
Version	3.1
Effective Date	February 2026
Document Owner	Sumit Sadhu
Last Reviewed	February 2026
Next Review Due	August 2026
Classification	Internal Use

Change Log

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	Feb 2026	Sumit Sadhu	Initial release
2.0	Feb 2026	Sumit Sadhu	Added AI Admin role, exclusion lists, delegation details, configuration procedures
3.0	Feb 2026	Sumit Sadhu	Major update: Fixed dual-licensing inaccuracy, corrected Assisted Hours formula, added Copilot Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, discovery questions, architecture diagram, RACI matrices, LOE summary, FAQ, Quick-Start Cheat Sheet. Consolidated org data guidance.
3.1	Feb 2026	Sumit Sadhu	**Major update:** Fixed dual-licensing inaccuracy (Sec 7), corrected Assisted Hours formula (Sec 5.4), added Copilot Analytics Reports section (Sec 6), added Agent Dashboard section (Sec 7), added Pre-Configuration Discovery questions (Sec 2.4), added Architecture Diagram, RACI matrices, Expanded Section 6 (Copilot Analytics Reports): added complete report catalogue with OOB, shared, and advanced PBI templates; added prerequisites for viewing and creating reports; added 4-step guide (access → create → connect PBI → publish); added Publish Reports workflow. Expanded Section 7 (Agent Dashboard): added key metrics table, unique insights, agent-specific filters, 3 practical scenarios (post-launch review, cost governance, shadow AI detection). Expanded Section 8 (Advanced Analytics): added template catalogue (Copilot Impact, Business Impact, Studio Agents); expanded Steps 5-7 with detailed query creation walkthrough, PBI connection flow, and report settings configuration.

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary

- Architecture Diagram
- Quick Reference: Which Dashboard Do You Need?
- Level-of-Effort Summary
- Implementation Timeline Overview

2. Introduction

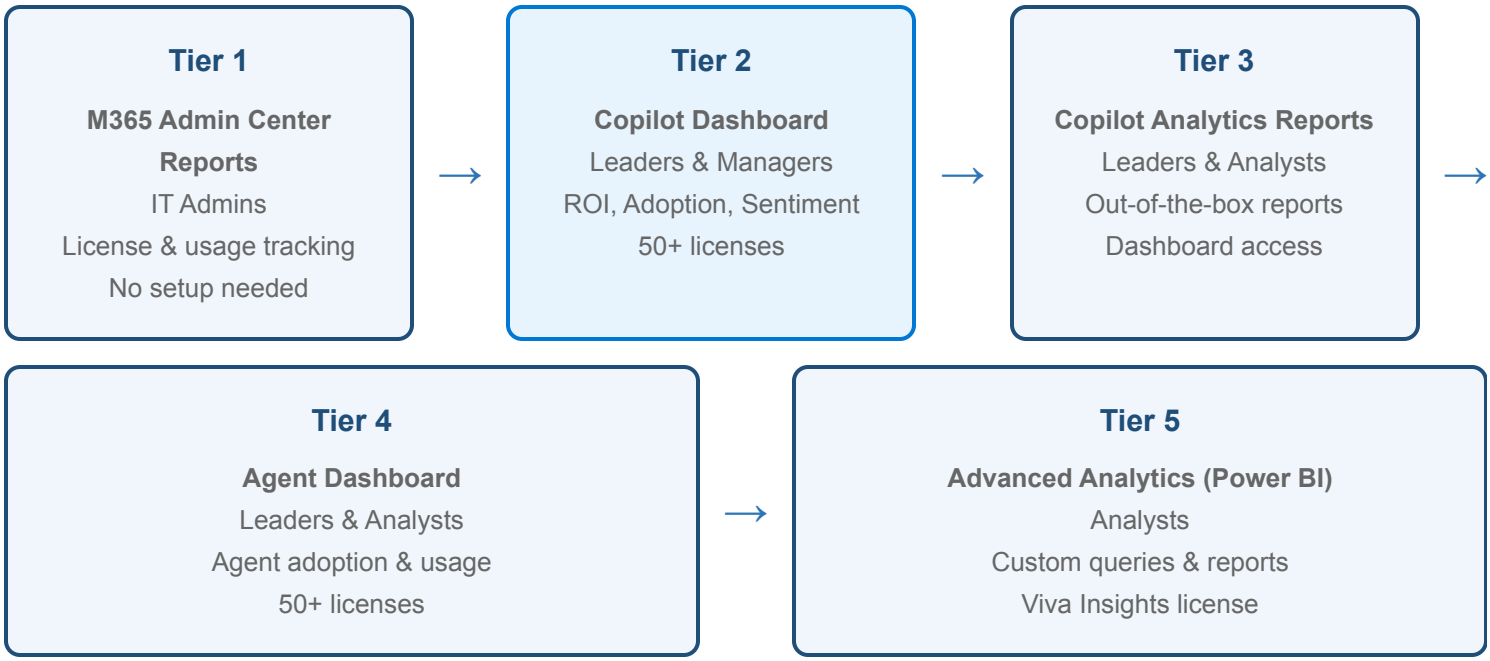
- 2.1 Purpose
- 2.2 Scope

2.3 Audience & Prerequisites
2.4 Pre-Configuration Discovery Questions
3. Dashboard Overview & Selection Guide
3.1 Dashboard Comparison
3.2 Decision Framework
3.3 RACI Matrix
3.4 Global Admin Readiness Checklist
4. Dashboard 1: M365 Admin Center Reports
5. Dashboard 2: Viva Insights Copilot Dashboard
6. Dashboard 3: Copilot Analytics Reports
7. Dashboard 4: Agent Dashboard
8. Dashboard 5: Viva Insights Advanced Analytics (Power BI)
9. Organizational Data Reference (Consolidated)
10. Troubleshooting Common Issues
11. Data Privacy & Compliance
12. Common Customer Questions (FAQ)
Appendix A: Further Considerations
Appendix B: Glossary
Appendix C: Additional Resources
Quick-Start Cheat Sheet

1. Executive Summary

This guide provides a complete procedural framework for implementing Microsoft 365 Copilot analytics and monitoring. It covers **five** distinct reporting tiers, each serving different stakeholders with varying prerequisites and capabilities.

Architecture Diagram



Progressive implementation: Each tier builds on the previous. All tiers share organizational data and privacy settings.

Quick Reference: Which Dashboard Do You Need?

Dashboard	Best For	Setup Time	Key Capability
Admin Center Reports	IT Admins tracking license usage	None (built-in)	User-level license utilization
Copilot Dashboard	Business leaders measuring ROI	Up to 7 days	Copilot Assisted Hours & Value
Copilot Analytics Reports	Leaders wanting targeted insights	Same as Dashboard	Out-of-the-box deep-dive reports
Agent Dashboard	Leaders tracking agent adoption	Same as Dashboard	Agent-specific usage & trends
Advanced Analytics (Power BI)	Analysts doing deep-dive analysis	1–2 weeks	Before/after adoption comparison

Level-of-Effort Summary

Tier	Active Config	Wait/Processing	Ongoing Maintenance	Personas Needed
Admin Center	15–30 min	72 hours	None	Global Admin or Reports Reader
Copilot Dashboard	2–4 hours	Up to 7 days	Monthly org data refresh	GA, AI Admin, Insights Admin
Copilot Analytics Reports	None (auto)	Same as Dashboard	None	Dashboard access holders
Agent Dashboard	10 min (verify)	Same as Dashboard	None	AI Admin, company-level delegates
Advanced Analytics	4–8 hours	Query-dependent	Monthly refresh + query re-runs	Insights Admin, Insights Analyst

Implementation Timeline Overview

- **Day 1:** Admin Center reports available (~72 hours after first Copilot usage)
- **Day 7:** Copilot Dashboard + Copilot Analytics Reports fully populated (if prerequisites met)
- **Day 7:** Agent Dashboard available (on by default as part of Viva Insights web app)

- **Week 2+:** Advanced Analytics operational (after org data upload and query setup)

> **TIP: Start Simple**
>
> Begin with Admin Center reports to establish baseline license tracking, then progressively enable Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, and Advanced Analytics as organisational maturity increases.

2. Introduction

2.1 Purpose of This Guide

Use this guide when a you want to get started with Copilot Analytics. It provides step-by-step procedures to configure all five Microsoft Copilot monitoring dashboards, from basic license tracking to advanced ROI analysis.

2.2 Scope

In Scope

- Microsoft 365 Copilot applications: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, Loop, OneNote, Edge, Copilot Chat
- Five monitoring tiers: Admin Center, Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, Advanced Analytics
- License utilization tracking, ROI measurement, sentiment analysis, and agent adoption
- Privacy configuration, exclusion lists, and delegation management

Out of Scope

- Other Copilot products: Copilot for Sales, Copilot for Service, GitHub Copilot, Security Copilot
- Custom Power BI report development beyond Microsoft-provided templates
- Third-party analytics integrations
- Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics independent of Copilot (meeting time, focus time, after-hours work, collaboration network analysis)

> **WARNING: Customer Wants Productivity Metrics Beyond Copilot?**
>
> If the primary interest is **meeting time, effort mapping, focus time, or collaboration patterns** independent of Copilot usage, those are delivered through the **Viva Insights Advanced Analysis** workbench — not the Copilot Analytics tiers covered in this guide. The same Viva Insights licence (included with Copilot) and the same Insights Analyst role are used, but the queries, templates, and metrics are different.
>
> Refer to the Viva Insights setup checklist and the Advanced Analysis introduction for that workstream. The org data upload and privacy settings configured in this guide carry over.

2.3 Audience & Prerequisites

This guide assumes:

- Level 200 familiarity with Microsoft 365 administration (Admin Center navigation, Entra ID basics, license assignment)
- No prior experience with Copilot-specific dashboards or Viva Insights
- Access to a tenant with Microsoft 365 Copilot licenses

> **NOTE: Terminology**
>
> Terms specific to Viva Insights (such as Assisted Hours, partitions, and organizational data) are defined on first use and compiled in Appendix B: Glossary.

2.4 Pre-Configuration Discovery Questions

Before touching any configuration, run through these qualifying questions:

#	Question	Why It Matters
1	How many M365 Copilot licenses are **assigned** (not purchased)?	Below 50 = limited dashboard features
2	Is the Entra ID manager hierarchy populated for most users?	Determines automatic vs. manual dashboard access. If >20% of users lack a Manager attribute, auto-identification and Manager Settings will be unreliable. See Section 9.1 for impact details.
3	Do you have an HR data export available (department, function, location)?	Required for group-level filtering and BU-level rollups
4	Has anyone been assigned the AI Administrator role?	Required to manage dashboard access and privacy settings
5	Do you have compliance/legal requirements to exclude specific users?	Drives exclusion list configuration (5-day processing)
6	Has Copilot already been rolled out, or is it pre-deployment?	Before/after analysis needs 4 weeks of pre-adoption baseline
7	Do you use Viva Glint or Viva Pulse for employee surveys?	Enables sentiment page with filters & heat maps
8	What is the primary reporting need: Copilot-only or broader productivity?	Determines whether standalone Viva Insights license is needed
9	Are you deploying Copilot agents / Copilot Studio agents?	Determines whether Agent Dashboard section is relevant
10	Who are the target report consumers (IT admins, BU leaders, analysts)?	Drives which tiers to prioritize

3. Dashboard Overview & Selection Guide

3.1 Dashboard Comparison

Capability	Admin Center	Copilot Dashboard	Analytics Reports	Agent Dashboard	Advanced Analytics
Primary Audience	IT Admins	Leaders, Managers	Leaders, Analysts	Leaders, Analysts	Analysts
Minimum Licenses	Any (1+)	50 Copilot OR Viva Insights	Same as Dashboard	50 Copilot OR Viva Insights	50 Viva Insights
Setup Complexity	None	Low–Medium	None (auto)	Low	High
Data Latency	~72 hours	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days	Query-dependent
User-Level Tracking	Yes	No (group-level)	No (group-level)	No (group-level)	Custom segments
ROI Metrics	No	Assisted Hours/Value	Yes (targeted)	No	Enhanced
Sentiment Data	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Agent Tracking	No	No	No	Yes	Yes (custom)
Before/After Analysis	No	No	No	No	Yes
Export Capabilities	CSV	Limited	Limited	Limited	Full Power BI

3.2 Decision Framework

1. Do you need user-level license utilization data? → Start with **Admin Center Reports**

2. Do you have 50+ assigned licenses AND want ROI metrics? → Enable **Copilot Dashboard**
3. Do leaders want ready-to-use targeted reports? → **Copilot Analytics Reports** (auto-available with Dashboard)
4. Are you deploying agents (Copilot Studio, etc.)? → Enable **Agent Dashboard**
5. Do you need before/after adoption analysis or custom segmentation? → Configure **Advanced Analytics**

> **TIP: Progressive Implementation**
>
> Most customers benefit from implementing all tiers progressively. Start with Admin Center (immediate), add Copilot Dashboard + Analytics Reports (week 1), then Advanced Analytics (week 2+) for comprehensive coverage.

3.3 RACI Matrix

Activity	Global Admin	AI Admin	Insights Admin	Insights Analyst	Business Leader
Assign Copilot/Viva licences	**R/A**	–	–	–	C
Assign Insights Admin/Analyst roles	**R/A**	–	–	–	–
Enable/disable Advanced Analysis (VFAM)	–	**R/A**	–	–	–
Configure Manager Settings	–	C	**R/A**	–	I
Upload organizational data	C	–	**R/A**	–	I
Configure privacy / group size	–	**C**	**R/A**	–	I
Create exclusion lists	–	**R/A**	–	–	C
Run Advanced Analytics queries	–	–	C	**R/A**	I
Delegate dashboard access	–	–	–	–	**R/A**
View & act on insights	I	–	–	**C**	**R/A**

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

3.4 Global Admin Readiness Checklist

When a Global Admin is asked *"Is everything set up for the analyst?"*, use this quick diagnostic. Each row can be verified in under 2 minutes.

#	Check	Where to Verify	Expected State
1	50+ licences assigned	Admin Center → Billing → Licenses → Microsoft 365 Copilot	≥50 in "Assigned" column
2	Insights Admin role assigned	Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Admins	At least one user listed
3	Insights Analyst role assigned	Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Add-on Plan → Insights Analyst	Analyst user(s) listed
4	VFAM — Copilot Dashboard ON	Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Turn Advanced Insights on or off	Copilot Dashboard = **On** for Everyone
5	VFAM — Advanced Analytics ON	Same screen as above	Copilot Advanced Analytics = **On** for Everyone
6	VFAM — Behavioral Experiences ON	Same screen as above	TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences = **On**
7	Org data uploaded	Viva Insights web app → Admin → Organisational data	Upload status shows "Complete"
8	Partition configured & analyst assigned	Viva Insights web app → Admin → Privacy settings → Partitions	Analyst listed on at least one partition (usually Global)

If any row fails, follow the corresponding section in this guide: licences (Section 5.3 Step 1), roles (Section 8.3 Step 1), VFAM (Section 5.3 Step 3), org data (Section 9), partitions (Section 8.3 Step 2).

4. Dashboard 1: Microsoft 365 Admin Center Reports

4.1 When to Use This Dashboard

- Track which users have Copilot licenses assigned vs. actively using Copilot
- Identify inactive licensed users for potential license reallocation
- Monitor per-application usage (Word, Excel, Teams, etc.)
- Export user-level activity data for custom analysis
- Quick visibility without additional configuration

4.2 Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Copilot License	At least one license assigned; no minimum threshold
Subscription Tier	Any tier supporting Copilot: E3/E5, Business Standard/Premium

Required Admin Roles

Role	Access Level	Can Export CSV?
Global Administrator	Full access to all reports and settings	Yes
Reports Reader	Full access to usage reports	Yes
Usage Summary Reports Reader	Aggregate data only; no user-level details	No
License Administrator	Manage license assignments only	No (no report access)

IMPORTANT: Role Assignment

request **Reports Reader** role. This provides full report access without Global Admin privileges.

4.3 Step-by-Step Implementation

Estimated Time: 15–30 minutes (plus 72 hours for data population)

Step 1: Verify Admin Role Assignment (5 min)

1. Navigate to **Microsoft 365 Admin Center**: `https://admin.microsoft.com`
2. Go to **Users** → **Active users** → **Select your account**
3. Click **Manage roles** and verify you have Reports Reader or higher
4. If not, request role assignment from Global Administrator

Step 2: Access Copilot Usage Reports (5 min)

1. In Admin Center, navigate to **Reports** → **Usage**
2. Scroll to find **Microsoft 365 Copilot** or use the search function
3. Click to open the Copilot usage report

Step 3: Configure Report Parameters (5 min)

1. Select timeframe: 7, 30, 90, or 180 days
2. Review summary cards: Total assigned licenses, Active users, Adoption rate
3. Scroll to per-application breakdown

Step 4: Export User-Level Data (5 min)

1. Click **Export** in the top right corner
2. Select CSV format
3. Open downloaded file to verify user-level activity data

NOTE: Data Availability

Reports populate within approximately 72 hours of user activity. If this is a new Copilot deployment, allow 3 business days before expecting data.

4.4 Success Criteria

- ☐ Can access Admin Center → Reports → Usage → Microsoft 365 Copilot
- ☐ Summary cards display: Assigned licenses count, Active users count, Adoption percentage
- ☐ Per-application breakdown shows usage across Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams
- ☐ Can export CSV file with user-level activity data
- ☐ Data is no older than 72 hours (check report timestamp)

4.5 Limitations

- No ROI or productivity impact metrics
- No sentiment tracking
- No group-level trend analysis
- No before/after adoption comparisons
- Data retention limited to 180 days maximum

4.6 What is Next

Once Admin Center reports are operational, proceed to the Viva Insights Copilot Dashboard (Section 5) to unlock ROI metrics and Copilot Assisted Hours/Value calculations.

4.7 References

- M365 Copilot usage report
- Admin roles overview
- Who can see reports

5. Dashboard 2: Viva Insights Copilot Dashboard

5.1 When to Use This Dashboard

- Business leaders need to demonstrate Copilot ROI to executives
- Track Copilot Assisted Hours (time saved through Copilot usage)
- Calculate Copilot Assisted Value (monetary value of time saved)
- Monitor adoption trends at group/department level
- Collect and analyse user sentiment about Copilot effectiveness
- Identify readiness gaps before broader rollout

> **IMPORTANT: Viva Insights Web App Dependency**
>
> The Copilot Dashboard is part of the Viva Insights web app. Previous standalone PowerShell controls for the Copilot Dashboard are no longer available. Access is now managed by enabling or disabling the Viva Insights web app itself—disabling the web app disables **all** features including the Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, and Advanced Analysis tools.

5.2 Prerequisites and Configuration

Licensing Requirements

Requirement	Details
Full Features	50 or more assigned Copilot licenses OR 50 or more Viva Insights licenses (combination counts)
Limited Features	Less than 50 assigned Copilot licenses (Readiness page + tenant-level only)
Viva Insights Service Plan	Automatically included with every Copilot license (no additional cost)

WARNING: 50-License Threshold

Organizations with fewer than 50 Copilot licenses will only see tenant-level adoption metrics. Group-level filtering and the full Impact page require meeting the 50-license threshold. This threshold can be achieved through a **combination** of Copilot and Viva Insights licenses (e.g., 30 Copilot + 20 Viva Insights = 50).

NOTE: Partial Rollout — Analytics Interpretation

If only a subset of employees have Copilot licences (e.g., 200 of 10,000), the dashboard **only measures licensed users**. Unlicensed employees are excluded from the "measured population." This means:

- Adoption metrics show "200 of 200 active" (not 200 of 10,000)
- Group filters (Department, Location) only show groups with licensed users in them
- Small rollout groups may frequently hit the minimum group size threshold, causing data suppression (N/A values)
- Before/after comparison data is only meaningful for licensed users

Recommendation: For rollouts under 500 users, focus on **Admin Center user-level reports** (Section 4) for adoption tracking and use the **Copilot Dashboard** primarily for ROI metrics. Consider increasing the rollout to 500+ users before investing in Advanced Analytics custom queries.

Required Admin Roles

Role	Assigned By	Capabilities
Global Administrator	N/A (built-in)	Full access to all settings; inherits Insights Admin privileges
AI Administrator	Global Admin	Manage dashboard access, enable/disable web app, create exclusion lists
Viva Insights Administrator	Global Admin	Upload org data, configure privacy & manager settings, manage partitions
Insights Analyst	Global/Insights Admin	Run advanced queries; with global partition → automatic dashboard access

What Each Role Sees in the Viva Insights Web App

Use this table to verify your role is working correctly. If what you see doesn’t match, check role assignment in Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights.

Role	Left Nav You'll See	What You Can Do	What You Can't Do	If You Need More
AI Administrator	Admin panel visible (General, Delegation, Manager settings, Privacy settings). **No** "Create analysis" button. May **not** see Copilot Dashboard.	Enable/disable VFAM features, manage user access, configure exclusion lists, set minimum group size	View the Copilot Dashboard (must add yourself explicitly). Create or run queries. Upload org data.	Add yourself to dashboard access: Admin Center → Viva → Manage user access for Copilot Dashboard
Insights Admin	Admin panel: Data quality, Data hub, Organisational data, Business data, Survey data, General, Delegation, Manager settings, Privacy settings. **No** "Create analysis" button.	Upload org data, configure privacy & manager settings, create partitions, assign analysts to partitions	Create or run queries (requires Insights Analyst role). View Copilot Dashboard (requires separate access).	Request Insights Analyst role from Global Admin if you also need to run queries
Insights Analyst	Analysis section: Publish reports, Create analysis, Analysis results, Metric rules, Metric library. **No** Admin panel.	Create and run queries, connect Power BI, publish reports, access Copilot Dashboard (if on global partition)	Upload org data, change privacy settings, manage partitions, configure manager settings.	Request Insights Admin role if you also need to configure settings
AI Admin + Insights Admin	Full Admin panel (both sets of settings). No "Create analysis".	All admin tasks: VFAM, access, org data, privacy, partitions, manager settings, exclusions	Create or run queries. Must still add yourself to dashboard access explicitly.	Add Insights Analyst role for query access
AI Admin + Insights Admin + Insights Analyst	Full Admin panel **AND** Analysis section with "Create analysis" button.	Everything: configure, query, publish, view dashboard	Nothing (full access within Viva Insights scope)	N/A — full access

> **WARNING: AI Administrator Access Gotcha**
>
> The AI Administrator role does **NOT** grant automatic access to view the Copilot Dashboard. AI Admins must explicitly add themselves via the access management settings. This is a common point of confusion during implementations.

Access Requirements

Access Type	Requirements
Automatic (Entra ID)	Tenant has 2,500+ users; majority in single reporting line; user in top 3 org levels OR has significant direct reports; criteria analysed weekly
Manager Access	User must have Viva Insights license + manager hierarchy in Entra ID or uploaded org data + **Insights Admin must enable via Manager Settings**
Delegated Access	User with dashboard access grants access to others; max 75 delegates; scope can be group or company-wide
Analyst Access	Viva Insights Analyst with global partition access gets automatic dashboard access

Configuration Processing Times

Configuration Change	Processing Time
User/group access changes	24 hours
Manager settings changes	1 hour
Organizational data upload	Up to 7 days
Minimum group size change	24 hours
Exclusion list upload	Up to 5 days
Exclusion list removal	Up to 3 days
Initial dashboard data population	Up to 7 days after licenses assigned

5.3 End-to-End Copilot Dashboard Enablement

Estimated Time: 2–4 hours active configuration + up to 7 days for data processing

This section covers the complete sequence to get the Copilot Dashboard operational — from licence verification through to first data appearing. Follow each step in order.

Step 1: Verify Licence Threshold (10 min)

1. Navigate to `https://admin.microsoft.com`
2. Go to **Billing** → **Licenses**
3. Locate Microsoft 365 Copilot and note the **assigned** count (not purchased)
4. Confirm 50 or more licenses are assigned
5. If less than 50, consider whether to expand licensing

Step 2: Verify Entra ID Hierarchy (15 min)

1. Navigate to `https://entra.microsoft.com`
2. Go to **Users** → select several sample users across different levels
3. For each user, verify the **Manager** attribute is populated
4. If hierarchy is incomplete, work with your directory team to populate
5. Note: Automatic access criteria are analysed weekly by Microsoft

Step 3: Verify VFAM Policies Are Enabled (10 min)

Requires **AI Administrator** or **Global Administrator** role. This step ensures no previous admin has disabled critical features.

1. Navigate to `https://admin.microsoft.com`
2. Go to **Settings** → **Microsoft Viva** → **Viva Insights**
3. Select the **Set up and management** tab
4. Under **Access management**, select **Turn Advanced Insights on or off**
5. You will see the **Viva Insights** policy list. Verify the following are set to **On**:

Policy	Required State	What Happens If Off
Copilot Dashboard (Enable Copilot Dashboard)	On	Nobody can view the dashboard — all other steps are pointless
Copilot Dashboard Delegation	On	Users cannot share dashboard access with delegates
Behavioral Experiences	On	Collaboration data (meeting time, email, chat) does not flow — breaks Impact page comparisons
Auto CxO Identification (Dashboard AutoEnablement)	On (recommended)	Senior leaders do not get automatic access — must be added manually
Copilot Advanced Analytics	On (if planning Section 8)	Analysts cannot access the Advanced Analysis workbench

If any policy shows **Off** or is scoped to specific users instead of **Everyone**, verify whether this was intentional. If not, select the policy → edit → set to **On** for **Everyone** (or the appropriate scope).

IMPORTANT: This Is the #1 Cause of "Dashboard Not Working"

If a previous admin created a custom VFAM policy that restricts the Copilot Dashboard to specific users, new users added via the access management settings **will not be able to view the dashboard** unless they are also included in the VFAM policy. Always check this screen first when troubleshooting access issues.

Accidental VFAM disable — blast radius & recovery: If the Copilot Dashboard policy is turned **Off**:

- **All users** (auto-identified leaders, manually added users, and delegates) immediately lose dashboard access
- Delegates are **not** removed — their delegation records survive, but they can't access the dashboard until the policy is re-enabled
- **Recovery:** Turn the policy back On for Everyone (or the required scope). Access takes **up to 24 hours** to propagate. No data is lost during the outage.
- **Prevention:** Restrict VFAM policy editing to Global Administrators only. Document which policies are enabled and why in your admin runbook.

Step 4: Configure Dashboard Access — Who Should See It (20 min)

Requires **AI Administrator** or **Global Administrator** role.

There are three ways users get access to the Copilot Dashboard. Decide which apply:

Access Method	Who Gets Access	How to Configure
Automatic (Entra ID)	Senior leaders in top 3 org levels with significant reporting lines (tenants with 2,500+ users)	No action needed — happens automatically if Auto CxO Identification is ON. Refreshed weekly.
Manual (Admin-assigned)	Specific users or groups you choose — AI Admins, BU leaders, HR, analysts, etc.	Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Set up and management → Under **Copilot Dashboard**, select **Manage user access** → Add users/groups
Delegated	People that existing dashboard users choose to share with (max 75 per person)	Configured by users themselves via Settings → Delegation in the Viva Insights web app. No admin action needed.

Recommended approach: Enable automatic access for senior leaders + manually add the AI Admin, Insights Admin, Insights Analyst, and any additional stakeholders (BU leaders, HR, change management leads).

IMPORTANT: AI Admin Self-Access

If you are an AI Administrator and need to view the dashboard yourself, you must add yourself using the manual access method above. The AI Administrator role does not grant automatic dashboard viewing access.

Step 5: Enable Manager Access to Team-Level Data (15 min)

Requires **Insights Administrator** or **AI Admin** role.

1. Navigate to Viva Insights web app: `https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
2. Go to **Manager Settings** (under Platform Setup on the left)
3. Toggle on **"Grant managers scoped access to Copilot insights"**
4. Set the **Minimum team size** (minimum 5; includes manager in count)
5. Choose which managers to enable:
   - **All managers** — all measured managers meeting team size threshold
   - **Select Active Directory group** — choose from Entra ID data
   - **Upload .csv file** — list specific manager email addresses
6. Click **Save changes** (takes effect within 1 hour)

Alternative path via Admin Center: Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Set up and management → Under **Copilot Dashboard**, select **Turn Insights for Managers on or off** and **Assign group managers to Insights for Managers**.

Step 6: Upload Organizational Data (30–45 min)

See Section 9: Organizational Data Reference for full details on both upload methods and attribute mapping.

Step 7: Configure Minimum Group Size for Privacy (10 min)

Default is 10; minimum allowed is 5.

For tenants WITHOUT Viva Insights license:

1. `https://admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights
2. Under **Copilot Dashboard**, select **Manage minimum group size**
3. Enter preferred minimum (≥5) → Save (takes effect in 24 hours)

For tenants WITH Viva Insights license:

1. `https://insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → Privacy settings
2. Configure minimum group size → Save (takes effect in 24 hours)

Step 8: Create Exclusion List (Optional, 20 min)

Requires AI Administrator role.

1. `https://admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights
2. Select **Unified exclusion list**
3. Choose method: CSV upload (PersonId column), Entra ID groups, or Replace all
4. Wait up to 5 days for exclusion to take effect

> **NOTE: Exclusion List Scope**
>
> The exclusion list removes users from both the Copilot Dashboard AND Viva Insights collaboration reports in Advanced Analysis. It also excludes M365 Copilot Chat (web) usage data.

Step 9: Configure Hourly Rate for ROI (10 min)

1. `https://insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → Impact settings
2. Default hourly rate is $72/hour (USD)
3. Adjust to customer loaded labour rate if different
4. Document the rate used for future reference

How to calculate a loaded labour rate: (Average base salary + benefits + overheads) ÷ annual productive hours (typically ~1,880). For Australian customers, consider using AUD values directly — the dashboard displays in the currency you enter but does not convert. Example: AUD $95/hour for a mid-level professional.

Important: Changing the hourly rate **retroactively recalculates** all Copilot Assisted Value figures displayed on the dashboard. Agree on the rate with stakeholders before changing it, and document both the old and new values for reporting continuity.

Step 10: Configure Sentiment Surveys (Optional, 30 min)

Option A: Viva Glint or Viva Pulse — Requires separate licences; enables filters & heat maps.

Option B: CSV Upload (Viva Insights customers) — Upload to Viva Insights Admin → Survey data.

Option C: Aggregated Results Upload (Non-Viva) — Admin Center → Reports → Adoption → AI assistance. Summary view only; no filters or heat maps.

Step 11: Wait for Data Processing

- Initial data processing: up to 7 days after licenses assigned
- Ongoing refresh: daily, 28-day rolling window, ~6-day delay from current date
- Newly licensed employees: additional up to 7-day delay before inclusion

5.4 Understanding Dashboard Pages

Readiness Page

Shows license assignment status and readiness for Copilot adoption. Available even with less than 50 licenses.

Adoption Page

Displays group-level usage trends, active user counts, usage intensity, and consistent usage metrics. Supports internal and external benchmark comparisons. Requires 50+ assigned licenses for group filtering.

Impact Page

Shows Copilot Assisted Hours and Copilot Assisted Value. This is the primary ROI metric page.

NOTE: Copilot Assisted Hours Calculation (Corrected)

Assisted Hours is composed of three categories:

Category	What's counted	Assistance factor
Meeting Summaries	Duration of each meeting summarized or recapped by Copilot. If a user both summarizes mid-meeting and accesses Intelligent Recap after, the meeting is counted once for the most recent action.	Actual meeting duration (variable)
Search & Summaries	Copilot Chat (work) prompts, Summarize email/Word/PPT actions, Excel analysis, Chat in Word/PPT/Excel prompts	6 minutes per action (based on Microsoft study #4)
Content Creation	Draft email, Draft in Word, Create presentation, Rewrite text actions	6 minutes per action

Assisted Value = Assisted Hours × Hourly Rate (default $72/hour, configurable)

These are broad approximations based on best available research. Microsoft may update the methodology.

Sentiment Page

Displays survey response data about user perception. Requires survey platform integration. Filters and heat maps only available with Viva Insights licence or CSV upload.

5.5 How to Delegate Access (For Dashboard Users)

Method 1 — Via Settings: Viva Insights web app → Settings → Delegation → Add delegates.

Method 2 — Via Dashboard: On Copilot Dashboard page → Share → Add delegates.

Delegation Limits:

- Maximum 75 delegates per person
- Delegates cannot delegate to others (no cascading)
- If delegator loses access (or leaves the org), all their delegates also lose access. **Recovery:** Another user with dashboard access must re-delegate to the affected people. Use Purview audit logs (Section

10.6 — search for `RemoveDelegates`) to identify who was affected. **Prevention:** Ensure at least 2–3 people have direct dashboard access (not just delegated) to avoid single points of failure.

- Senior leaders can assign scope: *Your group* (reports) OR *Your company* (all employees)
- Agent Dashboard requires "Your company" scope for delegates

5.6 Success Criteria

- ☐ Can access Copilot Dashboard at `https://insights.cloud.microsoft/#/CopilotDashboard`
- ☐ Readiness page displays license assignment data
- ☐ Adoption page shows active user trends (if 50+ licenses)
- ☐ Impact page displays Copilot Assisted Hours and Value metrics
- ☐ Group-level filtering works (if org data uploaded)
- ☐ Manager settings enabled and managers can see team-level data
- ☐ Minimum group size is configured appropriately
- ☐ Hourly rate is configured for your organisation
- ☐ Exclusion list configured (if required for compliance)

5.7 Limitations

- No user-level detail (privacy thresholds aggregate to groups)
- No before/after adoption comparison
- 28-day rolling window limits historical trend analysis
- Limited export capabilities
- Sentiment filters/heat maps require Viva license or CSV upload

5.8 References

- Microsoft Copilot Dashboard
- Manage dashboard settings

- Delegate access
- Configure Manager Settings
- Feature access management

6. Dashboard 3: Copilot Analytics Reports

6.1 When to Use

- Leaders want **targeted, out-of-the-box insights** beyond the Copilot Dashboard summary pages
- Analysts need pre-built reports they can share with business stakeholders without building custom queries
- Organization wants deeper collaboration insights alongside Copilot adoption data

6.2 What Are Copilot Analytics Reports?

Copilot Analytics Reports are a set of ready-to-use reports available inside the Viva Insights web app under **Reports** in the left navigation. They provide a variety of targeted insights about adoption and impact of Copilot across the organization, including both Copilot-specific and broader employee collaboration patterns.

6.3 Prerequisites

To view these reports, you must meet **at least one** of the following:

1. You have automatic access to the Copilot Dashboard based on Entra ID data, or you are an enabled manager
2. You have been given delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard
3. You are a **Viva Insights Analyst** with global partition access
4. You are a Microsoft 365 Global Administrator

> **NOTE: No Additional Setup Required**
>
> If you have already set up the Copilot Dashboard (Section 5), Copilot Analytics Reports are automatically available. No additional configuration is needed.

6.4 How to Access

> **Accessing Copilot Analytics Reports**
>
> 1. Navigate to the Viva Insights web app: `https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
> 2. In the left navigation, select **Reports**
> 3. Browse available reports — these include out-of-the-box reports and any reports published by analysts

6.5 Available Report Types

Copilot Analytics Reports fall into two categories in the Viva Insights web app:

A. Out-of-the-Box Reports (for Leaders & Managers)

Pre-built reports that cannot be customised with unique filters or attributes. Select **View report** to see insights.

Report	What It Shows	Who Can Access	Documentation
Copilot Studio Agents	Adoption and impact of custom agents — top agents, agent-assisted hours, individual agent impact	Leaders, Managers, Delegates	Learn more
Copilot for Sales Adoption	Usage of Copilot for Sales across the org — which actions contribute to sales tasks, usage by group and app	Leaders, Managers, Delegates	Learn more

B. Shared Reports (Analyst-Published)

Reports created by Insights Analysts and shared with leaders, managers, and delegates. These appear with a **"Shared"** label. Recipients can view but not customise them.

Shared reports can be any Power BI report within Viva Insights, or a custom report that includes Viva Insights metrics, survey data, or Copilot metrics.

C. Advanced Power BI Report Templates (for Analysts)

Pre-configured templates that analysts run as queries, then connect to Power BI for full customisation.

Template	Purpose	Special Requirements	Documentation
M365 Copilot Impact	Primary ROI report — assisted hours, before/after adoption, Copilot vs non-Copilot comparison	Copilot + Viva Insights licences	Learn more
M365 Copilot Adoption	Detailed adoption patterns — usage trends, feature adoption, group comparisons	Copilot + Viva Insights licences	Learn more
Copilot Business Impact	Correlate Copilot usage with business outcomes (sales, CSAT, etc.)	Business outcome data uploaded; min 65 Copilot + 65 non-Copilot users	Learn more
Copilot Studio Agents (Advanced)	Agent-specific impact — assisted hours, session outcomes, Copilot Credits, time savings	50+ Copilot licences; at least one Copilot Studio licence; agent published in Production/default environment	Learn more
Copilot Employee Experience (Glint)	Combine Copilot usage with Viva Glint survey data for employee experience analysis	Viva Glint licence + Copilot licence for measured population	Learn more

6.6 Prerequisites for Accessing Reports

For Viewing Out-of-the-Box & Shared Reports

You must meet **at least one** of the following:

1. Automatic access to the Copilot Dashboard based on Entra ID data, or enabled as a manager via Manager Settings
2. Delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard (Learn how)
3. **Insights Analyst** role with global partition access
4. Microsoft 365 Global Administrator

For Creating Advanced Power BI Reports (Analyst Templates)

Prerequisite	Details
Insights Analyst role	Assigned by Global Admin or Insights Admin (Assign roles)
Power BI Desktop	December 2022 or newer (free download: Get Power BI)
Viva Insights licence	Assigned to the measured population (included with Copilot licences)
Copilot licence	Assigned to employees whose Copilot activity you want to analyse
Partition access	Analyst must have access to the correct data partition (usually Global)
Org data uploaded	Required for group-by and filtering in reports (see Section 9)

NOTE: No Reports Visible?

If you see "No reports available", either: (a) no out-of-the-box reports are enabled for your tenant, or (b) no analyst has published shared reports to you. Contact your Insights Administrator to assign someone the Insights Analyst role so they can create and publish reports.

6.7 Step-by-Step: How to Create & Publish Reports

Step 1: Access Copilot Analytics Reports (Leaders/Managers)

1. Sign in to `https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
2. Select **Reports** in the left navigation
3. Browse **Out-of-the-box** reports (e.g., Copilot Studio Agents, Copilot for Sales)
4. Select **View report** on any card to see the insights
5. Look for **Shared** reports published by your analysts

Step 2: Create an Advanced Report Using a Template (Analysts)

1. Sign in to the analyst experience at `https://analysis.insights.viva.office.com`
2. Select **Create analysis**
3. Under **Templates**, browse the **Copilot** section
4. Select the desired template (e.g., **Copilot Impact** → **Set up analysis**)
5. Configure **Query setup**: name, time period (up to 13 months), auto-refresh, description
6. Review **Predefined metrics** (grey tags = required). Add extra metrics if needed
7. Set **Employee filters** (keep "Is Active"; add department/function filters as needed)
8. Add up to **20 organisational attributes** for group-by/filter options in the report
9. Select **Run** — the query may take minutes to hours

Tip: Use the Copilot assistant in Viva Insights to help choose metrics and filters. [Learn more]

Step 3: Connect Power BI to Query Results

1. Once the query completes, go to **Analysis results**
2. Download the **.pbit template file**
3. Open in Power BI Desktop → paste **partition ID** and **query ID**
4. Set **Minimum group size** → select **Load**
5. Sign in with your **Organisational account**
6. Configure report Settings: time period, group-by attribute, active user definition

Step 4: Publish Report to Leaders (Analysts)

1. While viewing the report in Viva Insights, select **Publish**
2. Create the card: set **title**, **publisher name**, **description**
3. Choose data access model:
   - **Unfiltered original report** — publishes as-is to people with Copilot Dashboard access
   - **Filter by manager hierarchy** — recipients see only their team's data (for enabled managers)
4. Set **expiry date** (up to 365 days)
5. Select **Publish** — recipients get an email notification and can view via the Reports tab

Report expiry: Published reports expire on the date you set (max 365 days). Recipients are **not** automatically notified before expiry. Set a calendar reminder to re-publish before the expiry date. If the publishing analyst leaves the organisation, see Section 8.5 — Analyst Departure for transfer guidance.

Doc: Publish reports feature

6.8 Relationship to Other Tiers

- Copilot Analytics Reports **complement** the Copilot Dashboard — the Dashboard provides summary views; these Reports provide deeper drill-downs
- Analysts can publish collaboration insights through the **Publish reports** feature, making them available alongside Copilot insights
- Reports use the same organizational data and privacy settings as the Copilot Dashboard
- Advanced Power BI templates in Section 8 use the same analyst workflow described here

6.9 Success Criteria

- ☐ Can navigate to Reports in the Viva Insights web app
- ☐ Out-of-the-box Copilot reports are visible and populated
- ☐ Analyst can create a query using a Copilot template and connect to Power BI
- ☐ Analyst can publish a report that appears for leaders under Shared reports

- ☐ Leaders receive email notification and can view published reports

6.10 References

- Copilot Analytics Reports overview
- Power BI report templates introduction
- Copilot Impact report template
- Copilot Adoption report template
- Copilot Business Impact report template
- Copilot Studio Agents report template
- Copilot Employee Experience (Glint) report
- Publish reports feature
- Copilot Analytics Introduction
- Use Copilot to help set up queries
- Copilot Advanced Analytics Playbook

7. Dashboard 4: Agent Dashboard

PREVIEW: Agent Dashboard

The Agent Dashboard is currently in public preview. Features may change before general availability. See the "Previews" section of the Microsoft Products and Services Data Protection Addendum for more information on personal data processing during previews.

7.1 When to Use This Dashboard

- Organization is deploying **Copilot agents** (via Copilot Studio, in-app agents, or third-party agents)
- Leaders want to understand agent adoption, active users, and usage trends
- Need to identify which agents are being used most and by whom
- Track agent adoption over time to optimize deployment

7.2 Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Copilot/Viva Insights Licenses	50+ assigned Copilot or Viva Insights licenses (same threshold as Copilot Dashboard)
Viva Insights Web App	Must be enabled (Agent Dashboard is on by default as part of the web app)
Access	Company-level dashboard access (senior leaders, company-scope delegates, Insights Analysts, or Global Admins)

IMPORTANT: Team-Level Access Not Available for Agent Dashboard

Unlike the Copilot Dashboard, managers **cannot** access a team-level view in the Agent Dashboard, nor can they delegate team-level access. To enable delegates' access to the Agent Dashboard, you must assign "Your company" scope (not "Your group") when delegating.

7.3 How to Access

> **Accessing the Agent Dashboard**
>
> 1. Navigate to the Viva Insights web app: `https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
> 2. Select **Agent Dashboard** from the left navigation
> 3. If you don't see it, verify your access level (must be company-level access)

7.4 What the Agent Dashboard Shows

The Agent Dashboard focuses exclusively on **agent adoption and usage**. Unlike the Copilot Dashboard (which tracks Copilot across all M365 apps and includes ROI/sentiment), the Agent Dashboard answers a different set of questions: *which agents are being used, by whom, how often, and are users coming back?*

Key Metrics

Metric	What It Measures
Active agents	Number of agents with at least one active user in the last 28 days
Active users	Unique users with at least one agent response in the last 28 days
Agent responses	Total number of times agents responded to users
Returning users	Users active in both the current and previous 28-day period (stickiness metric)
% of Copilot users using agents	Adoption penetration — what fraction of your Copilot users are also engaging with agents
Copilot Credits	Credits consumed by agents (visible when Pay-As-You-Go is enabled)

Unique Insights

- **Most popular agent:** The agent with the highest number of active users
- **Most versatile agent:** The agent used across the most job functions (requires Job Function data)
- **Most shared agent:** Among user-built agents, the one with the widest reach
- **Agent deep-dive pages:** Click into any agent to see its individual adoption trends, response counts, and user breakdown by group

Agent-Specific Filters (Unique to This Dashboard)

Filter	Options
Agent creator type	User | Your org | Microsoft | Microsoft partner
Agent source	Agent Builder | Microsoft Copilot Studio | SharePoint | Microsoft 365 Agents Toolkit | Other Microsoft

Data Sources

Same three sources as the Copilot Dashboard: Entra ID (default), M365 Admin Center org data upload, or Viva Insights org data upload.

7.5 When to Use the Agent Dashboard — Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: Post-Launch Agent Adoption Review

Your organisation just deployed three Copilot Studio agents (HR FAQ bot, IT Helpdesk agent, Sales proposal assistant). After 4 weeks, the CIO wants to know: *"Are people actually using them?"*

Use the Agent Dashboard to: Compare active users across all three agents. Check returning users to see if usage is sticky or if people tried once and stopped. Use the agent deep-dive pages to see which departments adopted each agent. If the IT Helpdesk agent has high usage but low returning users, it may indicate the agent is not resolving issues effectively.

Scenario 2: Cost Governance for Pay-As-You-Go Agents

Your organisation enabled Pay-As-You-Go billing for Copilot agents. Finance wants to understand the credit consumption pattern before the next budget cycle.

Use the Agent Dashboard to: Filter by Copilot Chat licence type to see credit-consuming agents. Review the Copilot Credits metric per agent to identify high-cost agents. Cross-reference with the Admin Center Copilot Credits report for per-user and per-billing-policy breakdowns. Use this data to decide which agents justify the spend and which need optimisation or retirement.

Scenario 3: Identifying Shadow AI / Ungoverned Agents

Your IT governance team suspects employees are building and sharing agents without oversight.

Use the Agent Dashboard to: Filter by **Agent creator type = User** to see all end-user-built agents. Sort by active users to find the most widely used ones. Check the *Most shared* insight to surface user-built agents that have grown beyond a single team. Work with your admin team to decide whether popular user-built agents should be formally published through your organisation's app catalogue with proper governance.

7.6 Detect → Act: From Agent Dashboard to Agent Governance

The Agent Dashboard is your **detection** layer. When you spot an agent that needs attention, here's how to act on it immediately — without leaving the M365 Admin Center.

IMPORTANT: The Detect → Act Workflow

Step	Where	Action
1. Detect	Viva Insights → Agent Dashboard	Identify the agent: filter by Creator Type, sort by active users, check *Most shared* insight, review deep-dive page for usage patterns
2. Decide	Your governance process	Determine the action: approve and formalise, block, or monitor. Consider: Is it user-built or org-published? How many active users? Is it using sensitive data?
3. Act — Quick	M365 Admin Center → Copilot → Agents	Block the agent immediately, review its permissions, or approve it for the org catalogue (see Quick Actions table below)
4. Act — Policy	Power Platform Admin Center	Set DLP policies to prevent recurrence: block specific connectors, channels, or knowledge sources. Set DLP policies to prevent recurrence. See the *Copilot & Agent Governance* project for full configuration

Agent Governance Quick Actions (M365 Admin Center)

These actions can be taken by the **AI Administrator** or **Global Admin** directly in the M365 Admin Center.

Action	Navigation	What It Does
Review agent inventory	Admin Center → Settings → Copilot → Agents	View all agents previously used in Copilot Chat. See agent name, publisher, status, and usage.
Block a specific agent	Agents section → Select agent → **Block**	Prevents the agent from being used in Copilot Chat. Note: blocking currently applies to Copilot Chat only — does not extend to OneDrive, SharePoint, or Teams surfaces.
Approve for org catalogue	Agents section → Select agent → **Approve**	Makes the agent available org-wide through the app catalogue with admin oversight.
Review agent access policies	Admin Center → Settings → Copilot → Agent policies	Set tenant-wide policies for agent access, sharing, and publishing permissions.

> **TIP: For Advanced Governance**
>
> The quick actions above handle immediate response. For **preventive governance** — DLP policies, environment-level controls, agent sharing limits, publishing approval workflows, and Purview integration — see the **Copilot & Agent Governance** project (separate documentation).

7.7 Admin Configuration

Enable/Disable the Agent Dashboard

The Agent Dashboard is **on by default**. To disable:

Via M365 Admin Center:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Microsoft Viva** → **Viva Insights** → **Set up and management**
2. Under **Access Management**, select **Turn Advanced Insights on or off**
3. Select **Agent Dashboard** → **Add policy** to disable

Via PowerShell (VFAM):

```
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights -FeatureId AgentDashboard -Name DisableFea
```

AI admins can set policies at tenant, group, or user level. Both the Viva Insights web app control *and* the Agent Dashboard control must be enabled for access.

Minimum Group Size

Uses the same minimum group size setting as the Copilot Dashboard. Default is 10; minimum is 5. See Section 5, Step 6 for configuration steps.

7.8 Delegate Access for Agent Dashboard

If you have company-level access to the dashboards, you can delegate access. However:

- Delegates must be given **"Your company"** scope to access the Agent Dashboard
- Delegates with **"Your group"** scope can see the Copilot Dashboard team view but **not** the Agent Dashboard
- To update existing delegates: go to **Delegation settings** → Edit → change scope from "Your group" to "Your company"

7.9 Success Criteria

- ☐ Agent Dashboard is visible in the Viva Insights web app navigation
- ☐ Adoption page shows agent activity data for the last 28 days
- ☐ Organization/Job Function filters work (if org data uploaded)
- ☐ Individual agent drill-downs are accessible
- ☐ Delegates with "Your company" scope can access the Agent Dashboard

7.10 Limitations

- Preview feature — may change before GA
- No team-level/manager view (company-level only)
- No ROI or impact metrics (adoption focus only)

- Not available in GCC environments

7.11 References

- Agent Dashboard documentation
- Manage Agent Dashboard settings
- Delegate access (including Agent Dashboard scope)
- M365 Copilot Agents Admin Guide
- Copilot Control System — Agent Lifecycle

8. Dashboard 5: Viva Insights Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

8.1 When to Use This Dashboard

- You need before/after adoption comparison (Copilot users vs. baseline)
- Analysts require custom cohort segmentation (by department, role, location)
- Compare Copilot users' behavioural patterns against non-Copilot users
- Need full Power BI export and visualization capabilities
- Your organisation has dedicated analysts to maintain and interpret reports
- Historical data beyond 28-day rolling window is required

8.2 Prerequisites

Licensing Requirements

Requirement	Details
Viva Insights Licence	Required: 50+ assigned Viva Insights licences for advanced analysis. **Copilot licences automatically include the Viva Insights service plan**, so 50 Copilot licences satisfy this requirement.
Microsoft 365 Copilot Licence	Required for Copilot usage data (assigned to the users whose Copilot activity you want to analyse)
Power BI Desktop	Version June 2022 or newer (free download)

IMPORTANT: Licensing Clarification (Corrected from v2.0)

v2.0 of this guide stated that Advanced Analytics requires "BOTH Copilot licenses AND Viva Insights licenses" as separate purchases. This was incorrect.

Correction: Every M365 Copilot licence **automatically includes** the Viva Insights service plan. 50 Copilot licences alone satisfy the Viva Insights licence requirement for Advanced Analysis. A separate Viva Insights add-on purchase is only needed if you want to analyse employees who do *not* have Copilot licences.

Role Requirements

Role	Assigned By	Purpose
Insights Analyst	Global Admin or Insights Admin	Access to create and run queries
Partition Access	Insights Admin	Access to relevant employee partitions

IMPORTANT: Insights Admin ≠ Insights Analyst

These are **two separate roles** that serve different purposes. Having the **Insights Admin** role lets you configure settings (org data, privacy, manager settings, partitions) but does **NOT** let you create or run queries. For that, the user also needs the **Insights Analyst** role.

Common confusion: An Insights Admin opens the Viva Insights web app and sees the Admin panel with settings — but sees no option to “Create analysis”. They assume something is broken. In reality, the Create analysis button only appears for users with the Insights Analyst role. If one person needs to do both admin and analysis tasks, assign **both** roles.

Error you may see: If the tenant has fewer than 50 assigned Viva Insights / Copilot licences, the Admin page will display: *“Viva Insights is below the minimum assigned licence requirement for this experience.”* This means the tenant has not met the 50-licence threshold — resolve by assigning more Copilot licences (which include Viva Insights) or standalone Viva Insights licences. See Section 10 Troubleshooting for the full resolution path.

Data Requirements

Requirement	Details	Impact if Missing
Organizational Data Upload	HR attributes: Department, Job Function, Location, Level	Only tenant-level views; no segmentation
Pre-Adoption Data	4 weeks of activity before Copilot rollout	Cannot perform before/after comparison
Post-Adoption Data	4 weeks of activity after Copilot rollout	Insufficient data for impact analysis
User Adoption Dates	Ability to identify when each user got Copilot	Cannot accurately segment cohorts

WARNING: Plan Ahead

Before/after analysis requires 4 weeks of pre-adoption baseline data. If Copilot has already been rolled out, this historical comparison may not be possible. Identify this early.

8.3 Step-by-Step Implementation

Estimated Time: 4–8 hours active + query runtime + ongoing maintenance

Step 1: Assign Insights Analyst Role (15 min)

1. Identify the analyst(s) who will manage reports
2. In M365 Admin Center: **Settings** → **Viva** → **Viva Insights** → **Add-on Plan** → **Insights Analyst**
3. Add users → Save
4. Wait 1–2 hours for permissions to propagate

Step 2: Configure Partition Access (15 min)

A **partition** defines which employees an analyst can query. Most tenants have a default **Global** partition covering all employees. Multi-agency or multi-BU tenants may have separate partitions per agency.

To assign an analyst to an existing partition:

1. Navigate to `https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
2. Go to **Admin** → **Privacy settings** → **Partitions**
3. Select the partition (usually **Global**) → click **Edit**
4. Under the **Analysts** tab, select **Add analysts**
5. Search for the Insights Analyst by name or email → select → **Save**
6. The analyst can access this partition's data within 1–2 hours

To create a new partition (for multi-agency isolation):

1. On the Partitions page, select **New partition**
2. Name the partition (e.g., "Agency A")
3. Set the filter: choose an org data attribute (e.g., `Agency`) and value (e.g., "Agency A")
4. Assign analysts → **Save**
5. Repeat for each agency/BU

Reference: Manage partitions in Viva Insights

Step 3: Upload Organizational Data (30–60 min)

See Section 9: Organizational Data Reference. Ensure data includes EffectiveDate set earlier than upload.

Step 4: Install Power BI Desktop (15 min)

1. Download from `https://powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/`
2. Install version June 2022 or newer
3. Sign in with an account that has Insights Analyst role

8.3.1 Available Copilot Power BI Templates

Before creating a query, choose the right template for your analysis goal:

Template	Purpose	Key Analysis
Microsoft 365 Copilot Impact	Primary Copilot ROI report	Assisted hours, before/after adoption comparison, Copilot vs non-Copilot users across meetings, email, chat, documents, and Copilot Chat (work)
Copilot Business Impact	Correlate Copilot usage with business outcomes	Requires uploading business data (e.g., sales, CSAT). Shows how Copilot usage relates to the metrics that matter most to your organisation
Copilot Studio Agents	Agent-specific impact and cost analysis	Agent assisted hours, knowledge source references, session outcomes, Copilot Credits consumed, time savings multiplier (customisable)

For broader collaboration analysis (not Copilot-specific), additional templates include: Ways of Working, Manager Effectiveness, and Wellbeing. These use the same analyst workflow but draw on different metrics.

Step 5: Create a Report Using a Built-in Template (30-45 min)

This walkthrough uses the **Copilot Impact** template as an example. The same workflow applies to all templates.

1. Sign in to the Viva Insights analyst experience at `https://analysis.insights.viva.office.com`
2. Select **Create analysis**
3. Under **Templates**, navigate to the **Copilot** section and select **Microsoft 365 Copilot impact** → **Set up analysis**
4. Under **Query setup**:
   - **Query name:** Enter a descriptive name (e.g., "Copilot Impact Q1 2026")
   - **Time period:** Select from Last 1 month, Last 3 months, Last 6 months, or Custom date range. Copilot metrics are available for up to 13 months of historical data. For before/after analysis, ensure the range includes the period when Copilot was first deployed.
   - **Auto-refresh** (optional): Check this box to have the query automatically re-run when new data arrives
   - **Description** (optional): Add context for future reference
5. Under **Predefined template metrics**: Review the pre-selected metrics (shown as grey tags — you cannot remove these). Optionally add more metrics by selecting **Add metrics**
6. Under **Select which employees you want to include**: Add filters to narrow the population. Keep the predefined "Is Active" filter. Use org attributes to scope (e.g., Department = "Sales" if you want a sales-only report)
7. Under **Select which employee attributes you want to include**: Add up to 20 organisational attributes. These become your group-by and filter options in the Power BI report. Pre-selected attributes (grey) are required; blue attributes are recommended but removable
8. Select **Run** in the upper right. The query may take minutes to hours depending on population size

NOTE: Data Quality Warnings

If you see yellow warnings on attributes, the data quality is low. Red warnings with the Run button disabled mean the attribute is missing from your org data entirely. Resolve these by updating your org data upload before running the query.

Step 6: Connect Power BI to Query Results (20 min)

1. Once the query completes, download the **.pbit template file** from the query results page
2. Open the downloaded template in Power BI Desktop
3. When prompted:
   - Paste in the **partition identifier** and **query identifier** (shown on the results page)
   - Set the **Minimum group size** for data aggregation (must match your organisation's privacy policy)
4. Select **Load** to import the query results
5. Sign in using your **Organisational account** (the same account you use for Viva Insights). You may need to sign in more than once
6. Wait for Power BI to load and prepare the data (may take several minutes for large datasets)

Step 7: Configure Report Settings & Explore (30-60 min)

Once the report loads, configure the Settings page (accessible from the right panel or the Settings icon on any page):

1. **Time period:** Select the date range you want the report to display
2. **Group by:** Choose the primary group-by attribute (e.g., Organisation, Department). This applies across all report pages
3. **Filters** (optional): Select org attributes and values to filter the employees shown
4. **Customise active Copilot user definition:** Choose between:
   - At least one active day in the selected time period
   - At least one active day per four weeks
   - At least one active day per week
5. **Report language:** Change if needed

Explore the report pages:

- **Summary page:** Active Copilot users, total actions, Assisted Hours overview, with cards for Meetings, Email, Teams Chat, Documents, and Copilot Chat (work)
- **Per-section deep-dives** (each section has 3 analysis views):
  - *Before vs. after adoption:* How collaboration behaviour changed after employees started using Copilot
  - *Copilot vs. non-Copilot users across groups:* Compare active Copilot users against non-users by department, function, etc.
  - *Two-group comparison:* Compare two custom cohorts of employees side by side
- **Research insights page:** Links to Microsoft research on Copilot adoption and impact

WARNING: Before/After Analysis Requires Full Date Range

To accurately capture the first time employees began using Copilot, ensure your query time period extends back to when your organisation first enabled Copilot. For example, if Copilot was enabled in January 2025, include data from January 2025 onwards.

8.4 Success Criteria

- ☐ Insights Analyst role assigned and accessible
- ☐ Organizational data uploaded and processed
- ☐ Copilot Impact query created and executed successfully
- ☐ Power BI Desktop connected to OData feed
- ☐ Template report loads with data
- ☐ Before/after adoption comparison is visible
- ☐ Custom segmentation filters work
- ☐ Analyst understands how to refresh and modify reports

8.5 Ongoing Maintenance & Operationalisation

- Refresh organizational data monthly (or when org changes occur)
- Re-run queries periodically to capture updated data
- Update Power BI reports when Microsoft releases template updates
- Share reports with leaders and managers via **Publish Reports** (see Section 6.7 Step 4) or by sharing the Power BI workspace directly

Analyst Departure — Query & Report Transfer

If an Insights Analyst leaves the organisation, their queries and published reports require attention:

Asset	What Happens	Action Required
Completed query results	Results persist in the Viva Insights platform and remain accessible to other analysts with partition access	No immediate action. New analyst can view and download existing results.
Scheduled/recurring queries	Queries created by the departed analyst may stop running when their account is disabled	New analyst should recreate recurring queries under their own account before the old account is deleted.
Published reports (Publish Reports)	Published reports have an expiry date (up to 365 days). If the publisher's account is removed, existing published reports **remain accessible until expiry** but cannot be renewed.	New analyst should re-publish critical reports under their own account before the originals expire.
Power BI reports (.pbix files)	Local .pbix files are on the analyst's machine. Power BI Service reports are in their personal workspace.	Transfer .pbix files to a shared location (e.g., SharePoint). Move Power BI Service reports to a **shared workspace** and transfer ownership before account deletion. See Power BI account closure guidance.
Partition access	Access is per-user and is removed when the account is deleted	Insights Admin must assign partition access to the replacement analyst.

> **WARNING: Plan for Analyst Transitions**
>
> Always have at least two analysts with partition access. Store .pbix files in a shared workspace, not on individual machines. Document query schedules so they can be recreated if needed.

Suggested Steady-State Review Cadence

Once all tiers are operational, suggest the following review rhythm:

Cadence	Who	What to Review	Where
Weekly	IT Admin	Licence utilisation, inactive users for reallocation	Admin Center → Reports → M365 Copilot
Fortnightly	Business Leaders / Managers	Copilot Assisted Hours & Value trends, adoption by group, sentiment shifts	Copilot Dashboard (Impact + Adoption pages)
Monthly	Business Leaders	Copilot Analytics Reports for deeper drill-downs; agent adoption (if applicable)	Viva Insights → Reports; Agent Dashboard
Quarterly	Analysts + Exec Sponsor	Before/after cohort analysis, ROI report for board deck, refresh org data	Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

Leaders should use the **Copilot Dashboard Impact page** as their primary "at a glance" view, supplemented by Copilot Analytics Reports for targeted questions. Advanced Analytics Power BI reports are best suited for quarterly deep-dives and executive presentations.

8.6 References

- Copilot Impact Report (Power BI)
- Copilot Business Impact Report
- Setup Advanced Reporting
- Assign roles
- Copilot Advanced Analytics Playbook

9. Organizational Data Reference (Consolidated)

This section consolidates organizational data guidance for all tiers. Upload once; the data serves the Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, and Advanced Analytics.

9.1 Why Upload Org Data? (Entra ID vs. Org Data Upload)

A common question: *"We already have Department, Manager, and Job Title in Entra ID — why do we need to upload a CSV?"*

Entra ID provides a baseline, but org data uploads unlock significantly more analytics capability:

Capability	Entra ID Only	With Org Data Upload
Department filter on dashboard	Yes (Entra ID "Department" attribute)	Yes (from CSV — can use different/cleaner values)
Job Function / Job Discipline filter	No	Yes (via `FunctionType` / `Microsoft_JobDiscipline`)
Location filter	No	Yes (via `Location` attribute)
Level / Seniority filter	No	Yes (via `LevelDesignation`)
Custom attributes (Cost Centre, Agency, BU, Region)	No	Yes (up to 105 custom attributes)
Multi-agency / multi-BU partitioning	Not possible	Required (partitions filter on org data attributes like `Agency`)
Before/after cohort segmentation in Power BI	No segmentation	Yes (segment by any uploaded attribute)
Manager hierarchy accuracy	Depends on Entra ID completeness	Can supplement/override with CSV `ManagerId`
Data freshness control	Updated by directory team (often delayed)	Updated by Insights Admin on a defined cadence

> **TIP: When Entra ID Alone Is Sufficient**
>
> If you **only** need the Copilot Dashboard with tenant-level views and Department filtering — and the Entra ID Department attribute is accurate and consistently populated — you can skip the org data upload. However, if you need **any** of the following, org data upload is required: Location or Job Function filters, custom attributes (Cost Centre, Agency), multi-BU partitioning, or before/after cohort analysis in Power BI.

What Breaks with an Incomplete Entra ID Hierarchy?

If the Entra ID `Manager` attribute is missing or inconsistent for many users:

Feature	Impact
Auto CxO Identification (automatic dashboard access)	Fewer leaders are auto-identified. Users without a clear reporting line are excluded from the “top 3 levels” calculation.
Manager Settings (team-level data for managers)	Managers without a populated `Manager` attribute or without enough direct reports meeting the minimum team size will **not** see team-level data.
Filter by manager hierarchy (Publish Reports)	Published reports with “Filter by manager hierarchy” will show incomplete data. Managers without hierarchy data see nothing.
Advanced Analytics cohort segmentation	If `ManagerId` is missing in org data and Entra ID, manager-based grouping will be inaccurate.

Recommendation: Before deploying dashboards, run Section 5.3 Step 2 (Verify Entra ID Hierarchy). If more than 20% of users lack a Manager attribute, prioritise fixing directory data or supplement with an org data CSV upload that includes correct `ManagerId` values.

What Happens After Org Data Is Uploaded? (Reversal)

Once org data is uploaded, it **permanently replaces Entra ID as the data source** for dashboard filters. This means:

- Department values come from the CSV, not from Entra ID — even if they differ
- If you stop uploading, the data becomes stale (not reverted to Entra ID)
- To revert to Entra ID as the source, you must **contact Microsoft Support** to reset the org data configuration. There is no self-service reversal.

- **Before uploading:** Confirm readiness to own the ongoing refresh cycle (monthly re-uploads recommended)

9.2 Upload Methods

Method	Who Uploads	Best For
Option A: Viva Insights web app	Insights Administrator	Customers WITH Viva Insights licences (recommended — richer attribute support)
Option B: M365 Admin Center	Global Admin	Customers WITHOUT Viva Insights licences

> **NOTE: Merged Uploads**
>
> If both methods are used, the dashboard merges the uploads and prioritises the more recent data.

9.2 Attribute Mapping

Viva Insights Attribute	M365 Admin Center Attribute	Required?
`PersonId`	`Microsoft_PersonEmail`	Required
`ManagerId`	`Microsoft_ManagerEmail`	Required
`Organization`	`Microsoft_Organization`	Required
`EffectiveDate`	N/A	Recommended (set earlier than upload date)
`FunctionType`	`Microsoft_JobDiscipline`	Optional (enables Job Function filter)
`LevelDesignation`	N/A	Optional (enables level views)
`Location`	N/A	Optional (enables location filter)
Custom attributes (e.g., `BusinessUnit`)	N/A	Optional (up to 105 total attributes)

9.3 Upload Steps (Option A — Viva Insights)

1. Prepare CSV: UTF-8 encoded, <1 GB, include all required columns + custom attributes
2. Navigate to `https://insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → Data hub → .csv upload → Start
3. Upload file, map fields to Viva Insights attributes
4. Validate and submit — wait up to 7 days for processing

9.4 Upload Steps (Option B — M365 Admin Center)

1. Prepare CSV with `Microsoft_*` attribute names
2. Navigate to `https://admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Org settings → Organization profile → Organizational data
3. Upload CSV file — wait up to 7 days for processing

9.5 Re-Upload & Maintenance

Org data must be **fully re-uploaded** whenever changes occur (new departments, reorgs, location changes). There is no incremental/delta upload — each upload completely replaces the previous dataset.

Scenario	Action	Processing Time
New department added (reorg)	Update the CSV with new department values for affected employees. Re-upload the full file.	Up to 7 days
Employee moved between departments	Update their row in the CSV. Re-upload the full file.	Up to 7 days
Bad data uploaded (filters broken)	Re-upload the previous correct CSV immediately. The system will overwrite the bad data.	Up to 7 days
Switching from M365 Admin upload to Viva Insights upload	Upload via Viva Insights. The system merges and prioritises the most recent upload.	Up to 7 days

> **WARNING: Always Validate Before Uploading**
>
> There is **no automatic rollback** — if you upload bad data, filters will break for up to 7 days while the corrected file processes. Before uploading:
>
> 1. Open the CSV in a spreadsheet and verify column names match exactly (Section 9.2)
> 2. Confirm encoding is UTF-8 and file size is <1 GB
> 3. Check that `EffectiveDate` is set to a date **earlier** than today
> 4. Verify every employee has a `PersonId`, `ManagerId`, and `Organization`
> 5. Keep a copy of the previous CSV so you can re-upload it if needed

Recommended cadence: Re-upload org data **monthly** or whenever significant org changes occur (restructures, M&A, location moves). Set a calendar reminder for the Insights Admin.

9.6 Key Guidance

- Upload data for **every employee** to ensure Scope filters are accurate
- Do **not** upload a `TimeZone` column (will cause an error)
- Include `EffectiveDate` set to a date **earlier** than the upload date to avoid delays
- If both Insights Admin and Global Admin upload data, the dashboard prioritises the most recent upload
- Org data permanently changes the data source from Entra ID to the file — refresh regularly

10. Troubleshooting Common Issues

10.1 Admin Center Reports

Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution
No data appearing	Less than 72 hours since first usage	Wait 72 hours
No data appearing	No users have Copilot licenses assigned	Verify license assignment
Cannot export CSV	Insufficient admin role	Request Reports Reader role
User details hidden	Privacy settings enabled	Check Reports → Settings → Display concealed user info
Data shows 0 active users	Users haven't used Copilot	Confirm users have accessed Copilot features

10.2 Viva Insights Dashboard & Analytics Reports

Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution
Dashboard access denied	Copilot Dashboard VFAM policy is OFF or scoped to specific users	Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Set up and management → Turn Advanced Insights on or off → verify **Enable Copilot Dashboard** is ON for Everyone (or includes the affected user)
Dashboard access denied	AI Admin not added to access list	AI Admins must explicitly add themselves via Manage user access for Copilot Dashboard
Dashboard access denied	Delegation VFAM policy restricts delegates	Check **Copilot Dashboard Delegation** policy — if scoped to specific users, delegates must be included
Dashboard access denied	Less than 2,500 users in tenant (no auto-access)	Use manual access assignment or delegate access
Impact page missing collaboration data	Behavioral Experiences policy is OFF	Navigate to `admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Set up and management → Turn Advanced Insights on or off → verify **TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences** is set to **On** for Everyone. Changes take 24 hours to propagate.
Only Readiness page visible	Less than 50 assigned licenses	Increase assigned licenses to 50+
"Viva Insights is below the minimum assigned licence requirement for this experience"	Tenant has fewer than 50 assigned Viva Insights or Copilot licences	Assign 50+ Copilot licences (each includes Viva Insights service plan) OR standalone Viva Insights licences. Go to Admin Center → Billing → Licenses and verify the **assigned** count (not purchased). If recently assigned, wait 24–48 hours for propagation.
No group-level filtering	Organizational data not uploaded	Upload HR data (see Section 9)
Impact page shows no data	Less than 7 days since license assignment	Wait up to 7 days for processing
Data suppressed (N/A)	Group size below privacy threshold	Groups must meet minimum configured size (default 10)

Managers can't see team data	Manager Settings not enabled	Navigate to `insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → **Manager Settings** (under Platform Setup) → Turn on "Grant managers scoped access". Wait 1 hour for propagation. Also verify the manager has a populated ManagerID in Entra ID. (See Section 5.3, Step 5)
Sentiment page empty	No survey platform configured	Configure Viva Glint, Pulse, or upload survey data
Exclusion list not working	Processing not complete	Exclusion list changes take up to 5 days to process. Check status at `admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → **Unified exclusion list**.
Org data not showing	Missing EffectiveDate or wrong attribute names	Verify attribute names match exactly; include EffectiveDate. **Note:** M365 Admin Center uses `Microsoft_Organization` while Viva Insights uses `Organization` — they are different field names.
Org data not showing	Upload still processing (within 7-day window)	Org data uploads take up to 7 days to process. Check status: `insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → **Data hub** → verify upload shows "Complete" (not "Processing" or "Failed"). If failed, re-upload with corrected CSV.
Org data not showing	Upload failed silently	Navigate to `insights.cloud.microsoft` → Admin → **Data quality** to check for validation errors. Common failures: incorrect encoding (must be UTF-8), file >1 GB, missing required columns (PersonId, ManagerId, Organization).

10.3 Agent Dashboard

Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution
Agent Dashboard not visible	User only has "Your group" scope delegate access	Update delegate scope to "Your company"
Agent Dashboard disabled	VFAM policy disabling Agent Dashboard	Check AgentDashboard VFAM control; ensure both web app and Agent Dashboard controls are enabled
No agent data	No agents deployed or no agent activity	Verify Copilot agents are deployed and users are interacting with them

10.4 Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution
“Viva Insights is below the minimum assigned licence requirement for this experience”	Fewer than 50 Viva Insights / Copilot licences assigned in the tenant	Assign 50+ Copilot licences (each includes Viva Insights) OR add standalone Viva Insights licences. Check: Admin Center → Billing → Licenses → verify **assigned** count (≥50). Wait 24–48 hours after assigning.
Cannot access analyst experience	Insights Analyst role not assigned	Request role from Global/Insights Admin; wait 1–2 hours
Can see Admin settings but no “Create analysis” button	User has Insights Admin role but **not** Insights Analyst role	Insights Admin ≠ Insights Analyst. Assign the Insights Analyst role separately: Admin Center → Settings → Viva → Viva Insights → Add-on Plan → Insights Analyst. Both roles can be assigned to the same user.
Query returns no data	No users in selected partition	Verify partition access and employee filters
Query fails	Time period exceeds available data	Reduce query time period
Power BI won’t connect	Authentication issues	Sign in with account that has Insights Analyst role
No segmentation options	Organizational data not uploaded	Upload HR data before creating queries
Before/after unavailable	No pre-adoption baseline data	Focus on current-state analysis instead

10.5 Transient Errors & Service Issues

Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution
Dashboard shows blank page or “Something went wrong”	Microsoft 365 service incident or temporary outage	Check M365 Service Health (Admin Center → Health → Service health). Look for incidents affecting “Microsoft Viva” or “Microsoft 365 suite.” If an incident is active, wait for Microsoft to resolve it.
Dashboard loads but data is stale or missing	Backend processing delay	Dashboard data has a ~6-day processing delay. If data is missing beyond this window, check Service Health. No admin action required for processing delays.
Dashboard worked yesterday, broken today (no config change)	Browser cache or extension conflict	Try: (1) Clear browser cache and cookies for `insights.cloud.microsoft`. (2) Open in InPrivate/Incognito window. (3) Try a different browser (Edge recommended). (4) Disable browser extensions temporarily.
Intermittent “Access denied” errors	Token refresh issue or Entra ID sync delay	Sign out of all Microsoft sessions → clear browser data → sign back in. If persistent after 1 hour, check VFAM policies (Section 5.3 Step 3).
Power BI template fails to connect after working previously	Query expired or analyst session timed out	Re-authenticate in Power BI Desktop with the Insights Analyst account. If the query expired, create a new query run in Viva Insights.

TIP: Before Escalating

Before engaging Microsoft Support, always check: (1) Service Health dashboard for known incidents, (2) Try InPrivate browser, (3) Verify VFAM policies haven’t changed, (4) Confirm licences are still assigned. If none of these resolve the issue, escalate via Admin Center → Help and Support with tenant ID, screenshots, and timestamps.

10.6 Auditing Delegation Access

Use Microsoft Purview audit logs to track delegation:

Operation	Friendly Name	Description
`AddDelegates`	Added delegate access	User granted dashboard access to another user
`RemoveDelegates`	Removed delegate access	User revoked dashboard access from another user

TIP: Escalation Path

For issues not resolved by these steps, engage Microsoft Support via the Admin Center Help and Support section. Have tenant ID, license counts, and specific error messages ready.

11. Data Privacy & Compliance

11.1 Privacy Thresholds

- **Default minimum group size:** 10 users
- **Configurable minimum:** 5 users (lowest allowed); **maximum:** configurable up to 100
- **Regional requirements:** Some jurisdictions (e.g., European Works Councils, German Betriebsrat) may require higher minimums (commonly 25+). Always consult your legal/compliance team before setting the threshold below any regulatory or contractual requirement.
- Data suppressed for groups below threshold
- No individual user behaviour visible in Viva Insights dashboards
- **Differential privacy:** Automatically applied — randomly adjusts individual observations so aggregated results protect privacy
- **Distribution masking:** Automatically hides results where "almost all" or "almost none" fit a profile

> **NOTE: Minimum Team Size vs. Minimum Group Size**
>
> **Minimum team size** (set in Manager Settings) determines which managers can see their team's data. Includes the manager in the count.
>
> **Minimum group size** (set in Privacy Settings) is the smallest group shown in dashboards and Power BI reports for group comparisons.
>
> Both minimum values must be ≥5.

11.2 Exclusion Lists

- Removes users from Copilot Dashboard AND Viva Insights behaviour reports
- Also excludes M365 Copilot Chat (web) usage data
- Upload: CSV or Entra ID groups
- Processing: up to 5 days to apply, up to 3 days to remove

11.3 Data Residency

Viva Insights data residency follows the **Exchange Online mailbox location** for each user. This means:

- Collaboration signals (meetings, emails, chats) are processed and stored in the **same geographic region** as each user's Exchange Online mailbox
- Copilot activity data follows the same residency as the user's M365 tenant
- Organizational data uploads are stored in the tenant's primary data location
- **Australia:** If the tenant is provisioned in the Australia geography, data is stored in Microsoft's Sydney and Melbourne data centres. Verify in Admin Center → Settings → Org settings → Organization profile → Data location.
- **EU:** If the tenant is in the EU Data Boundary, data stays within EU data centres
- **Multi-Geo:** For tenants with Multi-Geo, each user's data follows their mailbox location

Reference: Viva Insights data residency | Microsoft 365 data locations

11.4 Privacy Audit Evidence

When an auditor requests proof that individual-level data was not exposed, gather the following evidence:

Evidence Item	Where to Find It	What It Proves
Minimum group size configuration	Viva Insights → Admin → Privacy settings	Groups below threshold are suppressed (no individual data visible)
Differential privacy enabled	Enabled by default — no admin toggle (always on)	Individual values are randomly adjusted before aggregation
Distribution masking	Enabled by default	Results where “almost all” or “almost none” match are hidden
Exclusion list	Admin Center → Viva Insights → Unified exclusion list	Named individuals excluded from all analytics
Delegation audit log	Purview Compliance Portal → Audit → search for “AddDelegates” / “RemoveDelegates”	Who granted dashboard access to whom, and when
VFAM policy list	Admin Center → Viva Insights → Turn Advanced Insights on or off	Which features are enabled and for which scope
Dashboard access list	Admin Center → Viva Insights → Manage user access for Copilot Dashboard	Exactly which users have dashboard access

Reference: [Viva Insights privacy overview]

11.5 GDPR and Regional Compliance

- Viva Insights designed with GDPR compliance in mind
- Users can opt out via their settings
- Organizational data uploads should follow customer data handling policies
- Consult customer legal/compliance team for specific regulatory requirements

11.5 Data Retention

Dashboard	Retention Period	Notes
Admin Center Reports	Up to 180 days (selectable)	No historical data beyond 180 days
Copilot Dashboard	28-day rolling window	Daily refresh; up to 6-day delay
Advanced Analytics (collaboration)	Up to 27 months	Initially 13 months, grows with weekly refreshes
Advanced Analytics (Copilot metrics)	Up to 13 months	Copilot-specific metrics only retain 13 months

12. Common Customer Questions (FAQ)

#	Question	Answer
1	Can managers see individual employee Copilot usage?	**No.** All data is aggregated at group level and protected by minimum group size thresholds, differential privacy, and distribution masking.
2	What happens if we drop below 50 licences?	The dashboard reverts to limited features (tenant-level only, Readiness page). Previously available group-level data is no longer shown.
3	Can we trial the Dashboard before licensing everyone?	The basic Copilot Dashboard is available to any M365/O365 tenant with Exchange Online — no paid Viva licence required. But full group filtering requires the 50-licence threshold.
4	Does the Dashboard track Copilot Chat (web) usage?	Yes, if Copilot Chat reporting is enabled in the tenant and you have 50+ Copilot or Viva Insights licences. There is a separate licence filter for Copilot Chat.
5	How often does the data refresh?	Daily for the Copilot Dashboard (28-day rolling window, ~6-day delay). Admin Center reports refresh approximately every 72 hours.
6	Can we see data by business unit or country?	Yes, but you must upload organizational data with those attributes. Without org data, only Entra ID Department is available as a filter.
7	Is a separate Viva Insights licence needed if we have Copilot?	**No.** Every M365 Copilot licence includes the Viva Insights service plan. Separate purchase is only needed to analyse non-Copilot users.
8	Can employees opt out of being analysed?	Users can opt out of Viva Insights personal insights. For advanced analysis, the Insights Admin can configure privacy settings and exclusion lists.
9	How is the $72/hour default calculated?	It is a broad industry estimate of loaded labour cost. Customers should adjust this to their own loaded rate for accurate ROI calculations.
10	Can we use the Agent Dashboard without Copilot Dashboard?	Both are part of the Viva Insights web app. You cannot enable one without the other being available, but access to each can be controlled separately via VFAM policies.
11	Who needs licences — only leaders viewing dashboards, or also employees whose data we want to analyse?	**Both.** Employees whose collaboration data you want to analyse must have a Viva Insights licence assigned (included automatically with every Copilot licence). Leaders and managers viewing dashboards also need a Viva Insights licence to access the full Copilot Dashboard and organisation insights. Unlicensed employees who collaborate with

		licensed users appear as “other internal collaborators” in aggregate but are not directly measured.
12	We already have Department and Manager in Entra ID — why do we need to upload org data?	Entra ID provides basic Department filtering only. Org data upload adds: Location, Job Function, Level, and **up to 105 custom attributes** (e.g., Cost Centre, Agency, Region). It also enables multi-BU partitioning and before/after cohort segmentation in Power BI. If your customer only needs tenant-level + Department views, Entra ID alone is sufficient. For anything more granular, upload org data. See Section 9.1 for the full comparison.
13	We uploaded org data and now our Department filter shows different values than Entra ID — can we go back?	Once org data is uploaded, it **permanently replaces Entra ID** as the data source for filters. There is no self-service reversal — you must contact Microsoft Support to reset. Make sure the CSV values match your intended naming before uploading. See Section 9.1.
14	We want broader productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time) not just Copilot reporting. Is that covered here?	**No.** This guide covers Copilot Analytics only. Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time, after-hours, collaboration networks) use the same Viva Insights licence and analyst role but are a separate analytics workstream. See Section 2.2 (Out of Scope) for pointers to the right resources. The org data and privacy settings configured through this guide carry over.

Appendix A: Further Considerations

1. **50-License Threshold Timing:** Should licensing be expanded before deployment to unlock group-level analytics? The threshold can be met through a combination of Copilot + Viva Insights licences.
2. **Entra ID Hierarchy Completeness:** Is the directory populated correctly? Criteria analysed weekly. If not, manual access assignment or org data upload is needed.
3. **AI Administrator Role Assignment:** Has this role been assigned? Required for dashboard access management, privacy, and exclusion lists. AI Admins must add themselves to view.
4. **Manager Settings Enablement:** Has the Insights Admin toggled on "Grant managers scoped access"? Without this, no managers can see team-level data even if they are licensed.
5. **Organizational Data Upload:** Is HR data available? Without it, only tenant-level views. Attribute names must match exactly. Include EffectiveDate.
6. **Hourly Rate Customisation:** Default $72/hour. Should be adjusted based on your organisation's loaded labour rate.
7. **Privacy Thresholds & Small Groups:** Default group size = 10. Small departments or pilot groups may see suppressed data. Consider when planning phased rollouts.
8. **Baseline Data for Before/After:** Needs 4 weeks pre-adoption data. If Copilot already deployed, comparison may not be possible.
9. **Compliance Exclusion Requirements:** Plan for 5-day processing time for exclusion list uploads.
10. **Delegation Policy:** Should delegation be allowed? If not, disable via `CopilotDashboardDelegation` VFAM policy.
11. **Agent Dashboard Scope:** If agents are being deployed, ensure company-level delegates are configured (not just group-level).
12. **Multi-Agency / Multi-BU Data Isolation:** If your organisation operates multiple independent agencies or business units within a single M365 tenant and requires that Agency A *cannot* see Agency B's Copilot usage data, the standard Copilot Dashboard does not provide hard data isolation. Senior leaders auto-identified via Entra ID hierarchy will see “Your company” data covering all agencies. The solution is a **partition-based architecture** using Viva Insights Advanced Analytics — create one partition per agency filtered by a custom “Agency” attribute in org data, assign agency-specific analysts, and deliver reports via isolated Power BI workspaces. The Copilot Dashboard itself should be restricted to Central IT only for tenant-wide licence management. See the *Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture* reference document for the validated solution, implementation runbook, and PowerShell lockdown steps.

13. **Copilot Agent Governance:** If deploying Copilot Studio agents and needs DLP policies, connector governance, agent sharing controls, or publishing approval workflows, these are managed through the **Power Platform Admin Center** — not through Viva Insights. See the **Copilot & Agent Governance** project for the full governance framework including tenant/environment/agent-level controls, DSPM for AI, and billing boundaries.
14. **Licence Lifecycle & Billing:** If you need to understand what happens to analytics data when licences are assigned, removed, or reassigned — or needs to manage Copilot Credits billing, Pay-As-You-Go metering, or multi-agency chargeback — see the *Copilot Lifecycle & Billing Playbook*.
15. **Broader Collaboration Analysis (Beyond Copilot):** If the you want meeting time, focus time, after-hours, wellbeing, or manager effectiveness metrics independent of Copilot, these use the same Viva Insights analyst workbench and org data but different templates and metrics. See the *Advanced Viva Insights Collaboration Analysis Guide*. The 4-week baseline window (item 8 above) is best captured using these collaboration templates.

Appendix B: Glossary

Term	Definition
AI Administrator	M365 admin role that manages Copilot Dashboard settings, access, exclusion lists, and privacy. Does NOT grant automatic dashboard viewing access.
Assisted Hours	Estimated time saved via Copilot — composed of meeting summaries (actual duration), search/summary actions (6 min each), and creation actions (6 min each).
Assisted Value	Monetary value of Assisted Hours: Assisted Hours × configured hourly rate (default $72/hour).
Auto-enablement	Automatic process granting senior leaders dashboard access based on Entra ID hierarchy. Refreshed weekly. Can be disabled tenant-wide.
Copilot Analytics Reports	Out-of-the-box reports in the Viva Insights web app providing targeted Copilot and collaboration insights.
Delegated Access	Manually granted dashboard access. Max 75 delegates per person. No cascading.
Exclusion List	Users excluded from Copilot Dashboard and Viva Insights analytics. Uploaded via CSV or Entra ID groups.
Insights Administrator	Viva Insights role with access to org data upload, privacy settings, manager settings, and partitions.
Insights Analyst	Viva Insights role that can create/run queries and access advanced analysis.
Loaded Labour Rate	Fully-burdened employee cost per hour including salary, benefits, and overhead.
Minimum Group Size	Smallest group shown in dashboards/reports. Default 10, minimum 5. Protects individual privacy.
Minimum Team Size	Determines which managers can see team data. Includes manager in count. Minimum 5.
Organizational Data	HR attributes uploaded to enable group-level filtering and segmentation.
Partition	Logical grouping of employees in Viva Insights. Analysts need partition access to query data.
Rolling Window	Data retention approach showing only the most recent period. Copilot Dashboard uses 28-day window.

VFAM	Viva Feature Access Management — PowerShell/admin center controls for enabling/disabling features at tenant, group, or user level.

Appendix C: Additional Resources

Links last verified: February 2026

Adoption & Success Resources

Resource	URL
M365 Copilot Adoption Hub	https://adoption.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/
Copilot Success Kit	https://adoption.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/success-kit/
Copilot Scenario Library	https://adoption.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/scenario-library/

Dashboard Direct Links

Dashboard	URL
M365 Admin Center	`https://admin.microsoft.com/`
Copilot Dashboard	`https://insights.cloud.microsoft/#/CopilotDashboard`
Copilot Dashboard Overview (aka.ms)	https://aka.ms/Copilot/DashboardOverview
Advanced Analytics Playbook	https://aka.ms/CopilotAdvancedAnalytics

Technical Documentation

Topic	URL
Copilot Analytics Introduction	learn.microsoft.com/.../copilot-analytics-introduction
Copilot Dashboard	learn.microsoft.com/.../copilot-dashboard
Copilot Analytics Reports	learn.microsoft.com/.../copilot-analytics-reports
Agent Dashboard	learn.microsoft.com/.../agent-dashboard
Manage Dashboard Settings	learn.microsoft.com/.../manage-settings-copilot-dashboard
Delegate Access	learn.microsoft.com/.../delegate-access
Configure Manager Settings	learn.microsoft.com/.../manager-settings
Upload Organizational Data	learn.microsoft.com/.../upload-org-data-first
Prepare Org Data	learn.microsoft.com/.../prepare-org-data
Privacy Settings	learn.microsoft.com/.../privacy-settings
Feature Access Management	learn.microsoft.com/.../feature-access-management
Assign Roles	learn.microsoft.com/.../assign-user-roles
Roles in Viva Insights	learn.microsoft.com/.../user-roles
Setup Checklist	learn.microsoft.com/.../setup-overview
Environment Requirements	learn.microsoft.com/.../environment-requirements
Admin Center Copilot Usage Report	learn.microsoft.com/.../microsoft-365-copilot-usage
M365 Copilot Reporting Options	learn.microsoft.com/.../microsoft-365-copilot-reports-for-admins
Technical Privacy Guide	learn.microsoft.com/.../privacy

TIP: Bookmark aka.ms Links

Use aka.ms short links where available (e.g., `https://aka.ms/Copilot/DashboardOverview`). These are Microsoft-maintained permanent redirects that survive documentation URL changes.

Quick-Start Cheat Sheet

One-Page Implementation Checklist

Tier 1 — Admin Center (Day 1)

- ☐ Verify Reports Reader role → `admin.microsoft.com`
- ☐ Navigate to Reports → Usage → Microsoft 365 Copilot
- ☐ Wait ~72 hours for data → export CSV to verify

Tier 2 — Copilot Dashboard (Day 1–7)

- ☐ Verify 50+ assigned Copilot/Viva Insights licences
- ☐ Verify Entra ID manager hierarchy is populated
- ☐ AI Admin: add self + users/groups to dashboard access → `admin.microsoft.com` → Viva → Viva Insights
- ☐ Insights Admin: enable Manager Settings → `insights.cloud.microsoft` → Manager Settings
- ☐ Upload org data CSV (PersonId, ManagerId, Organization + custom attributes)
- ☐ Configure minimum group size (default 10, min 5)
- ☐ Configure hourly rate for ROI (default $72/h)
- ☐ Optional: create exclusion list, configure sentiment surveys
- ☐ Wait up to 7 days → verify all 4 dashboard pages

Tier 3 — Copilot Analytics Reports (Auto)

- ☐ No action needed — automatically available to Dashboard users
- ☐ Verify: `insights.cloud.microsoft` → Reports (left nav)

Tier 4 — Agent Dashboard (Day 7+)

- ☐ On by default — verify visibility in Viva Insights left nav
- ☐ Ensure delegates have "Your company" scope (not "Your group")
- ☐ If agents deployed, verify agent activity data populates

Tier 5 — Advanced Analytics (Week 2+)

- ☐ Assign Insights Analyst role → wait 1–2 hours
- ☐ Grant partition access
- ☐ Ensure org data uploaded and processed (from Tier 2)
- ☐ Install Power BI Desktop (June 2022+)
- ☐ Create Copilot Impact query in Viva Insights analyst experience
- ☐ Connect Power BI via OData feed → apply template
- ☐ Configure scheduled refresh for ongoing reporting

Key URLs

M365 Admin Center	`https://admin.microsoft.com`
Entra Admin Center	`https://entra.microsoft.com`
Viva Insights Web App	`https://insights.cloud.microsoft`
Copilot Dashboard Direct	`https://insights.cloud.microsoft/#/CopilotDashboard`
Power BI Desktop	`https://powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/`

Key Wait Times

Admin Center data	~72 hours
Dashboard initial data	Up to 7 days
Manager settings change	1 hour
Access changes	24 hours
Min group size change	24 hours
Org data upload	Up to 7 days
Exclusion list apply	Up to 5 days
Exclusion list remove	Up to 3 days

--- End of Document ---

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics Implementation Guide v3.1 • February 2026

Disclaimer

This guide is provided as a procedural reference and may not reflect the latest product changes. Microsoft 365 features, settings, and admin experiences are updated frequently. Always refer to the official Microsoft Viva Insights documentation and Microsoft 365 Copilot documentation on Microsoft Learn for the most up-to-date information, procedures, and feature availability.